

RAJARATA UNIVERSITY OF SRI LANKA

Faculty of Technology

Department of Information and Communication Technology

ICT1209 – Web Technologies

Final Project Proposal

CampusFind

A Web-Based Lost and Found Management System for Rajarata University

Theme: University Lost and Found Management System

Group Members:

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Submission Date: 27/09/2026

1. Project Overview

1.1. Purpose

CampusFind is a web-based lost and found management system developed for Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. The main purpose of this system is to provide a simple way for students and university staff to report, search, and manage lost and found items within the university environment.

The system allows users to provide information about items they have lost or found. It also helps users search for relevant items through the website instead of depending only on notices or informal communication. By providing this platform, CampusFind aims to make the process of finding and returning lost items easier and more organized.

1.2. Target Audience

The main target users of CampusFind are **students and staff members of Rajarata University of Sri Lanka**.

Students can use the system to report their lost items, report items they have found, and search for items reported by other users.

University staff can also use the system to provide information about lost and found items.

1.3. Key Features

The main features of the CampusFind system include:

- **User Registration and Login** – Users can create an account and securely log in to the system.
- **Report Lost Items** – Users can submit information about items they have lost.
- **Report Found Items** – Users can report items they have found.
- **Search Items** – Users can search for lost and found items.
- **User Dashboard** – Users can manage and view their submitted information.

- **Contact Form** – Users can send messages or queries through the website
- **Login Required for Reporting Items** – Users must sign in to the system before they can report a lost or found item.
- **University Email Restriction** – Only users with a valid **@tec.rjt.ac.lk** university email address can register and access the system.

2. System Design

The system design describes the structure of the Lost and Found Web Application, including its database and project folder organization. The system was designed to keep the frontend, backend, and database components organized and easy to manage.

2.1.Database Schema

The application uses a MySQL database to store and manage the information required by the system. The database contains tables for user information, lost and found item details, and other system-related data. The database was designed to allow the PHP backend to store, retrieve, and manage information submitted through the web forms.

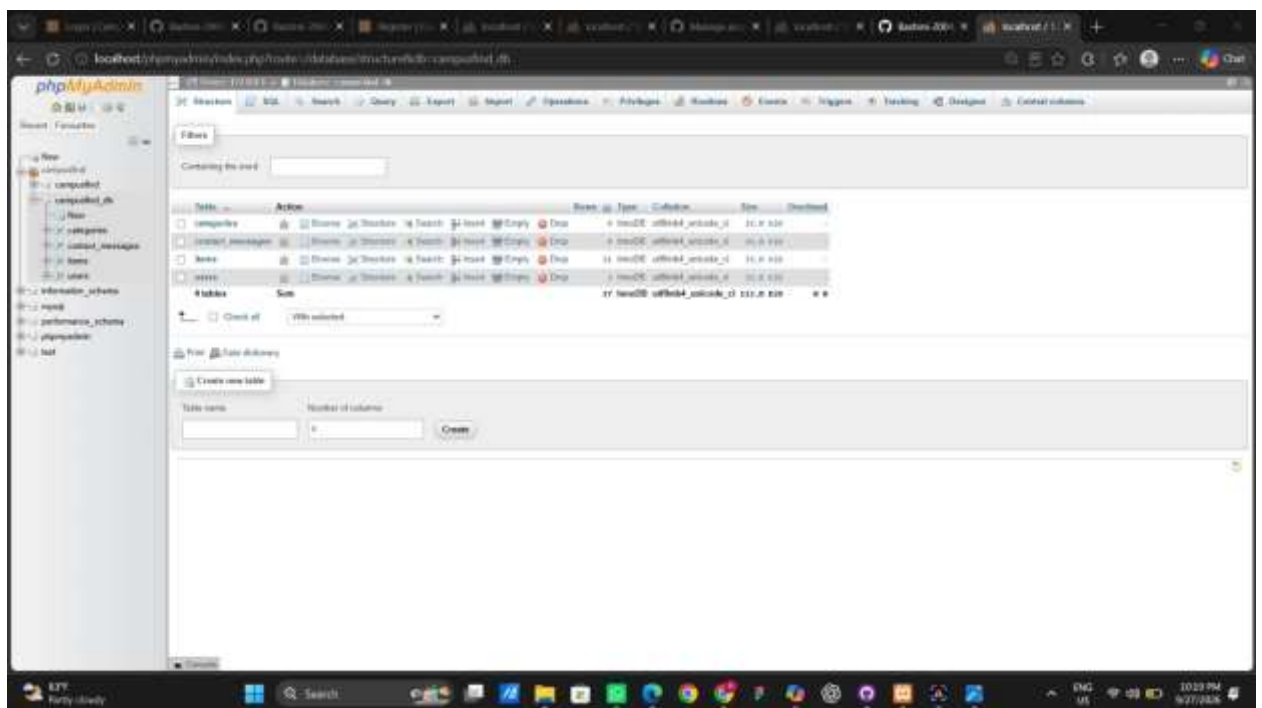
Database Name: campusfind

Main Tables:

Table Name	Purpose
users	Stores registered user account credentials, user names, emails, and roles.

Table Name	Purpose
reports	Stores reported lost and found item listings, including categories, dates, locations, and descriptions.
messages	Stores messages and inquiries submitted by users through the contact form.

Figure: Database Schema / Database Structure



2.2.Folder Structure

The project files were organized into different folders and files to make the system easier to develop and maintain. The frontend files contain the page

structure and design, while the PHP files handle the backend functionality and database communication.

Project Folder Structure:

```
RUSL-CampusFind/[cite: 1]
├── config/[cite: 1]
│   └── db.php          # PDO database connection & helper functions[cite: 1]
├── css/[cite: 1]
│   └── style.css       # Custom styling, campus palette, and card styles[cite: 1]
├── image/              # Static UI assets and sample item photos[cite: 1]
│   ├── logo.png[cite: 1]
│   ├── phone.jpeg[cite: 1]
│   ├── keys.jpg[cite: 1]
│   └── ...[cite: 1]
├── includes/[cite: 1]
│   ├── header.php     # Global navigation bar and session state[cite: 1]
│   └── footer.php     # Global footer and JavaScript scripts[cite: 1]
├── uploads/            # Storage directory for user-uploaded item photos[cite: 1]
├── about.php           # About RUSL-CampusFind & project background[cite: 1]
├── admin.php           # Administrator dashboard & moderation portal[cite: 1]
├── contact.php         # Contact inquiry form for students & staff[cite: 1]
├── contact_process.php # Backend handler for contact messages[cite: 1]
├── index.php           # Homepage with hero section & recent items[cite: 1]
├── login.php           # User & administrator login form[cite: 1]
├── login_process.php   # Authentication processing & session initiation[cite: 1]
├── logout.php          # Session termination & sign-out[cite: 1]
├── myitems.php         # User's personal reported items dashboard[cite: 1]
├── profile.php         # User profile information page[cite: 1]
├── register.php        # New user registration form[cite: 1]
├── register_process.php # Account creation processor[cite: 1]
├── report.php          # Item reporting form (Lost / Found)[cite: 1]
├── report_process.php  # Report processor & secure file upload handler[cite: 1]
├── schema.sql          # Complete database schema and seed data[cite: 1]
├── script.js           # Client-side form validation & live image preview[cite: 1]
└── search.php          # Search and filter lost & found items[cite: 1]
```

3. Implementation

The Lost and Found Web Application was implemented using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, JavaScript, PHP, and MySQL. The frontend was developed using Visual Studio Code, while PHP was used to handle the backend functionality and MySQL was used to store and manage system data.

The implementation was carried out step by step, starting with the frontend pages and then connecting the backend and database functions. The main features of the system were developed and tested to ensure that users could interact with the application effectively.

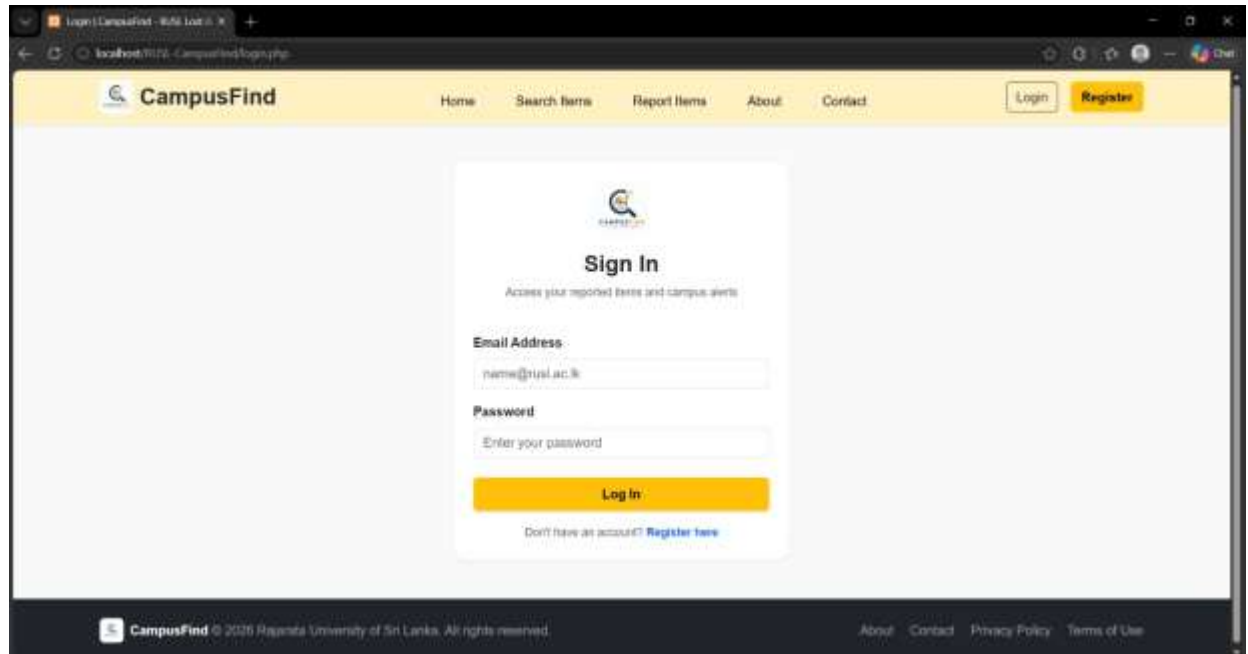
This section presents the major features of the system along with screenshots of the implemented pages and their functionalities.

3.1.Login Page

3.1.1. Feature: User Login Page (login.php)

3.1.2. Short Explanation: Enables registered students and staff members to log securely into their CampusFind account to manage reported items, access user dashboards, and submit lost or found reports.

3.1.3. Screenshot:



3.1.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top bar with the CampusFind logo, main navigation links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and top-right action buttons (*Login* and highlighted *Register*).
- **Sign-In Card Container:** Displays a centered white login card featuring the CampusFind icon, the heading "*Sign In*", and the descriptive line "*Access your reported items and campus alerts*".
- **Credential Input Fields:** Contains input boxes for "*Email Address*" (showing the university email placeholder *name@rusl.ac.lk*) and "*Password*" ("*Enter your password*").
- **Login Controls & Navigation:** Includes a prominent yellow "*Log In*" button to submit credentials for server-side authentication (*login_process.php*), along with a quick redirect link ("*Don't have an account? Register here*") leading to *register.php*.

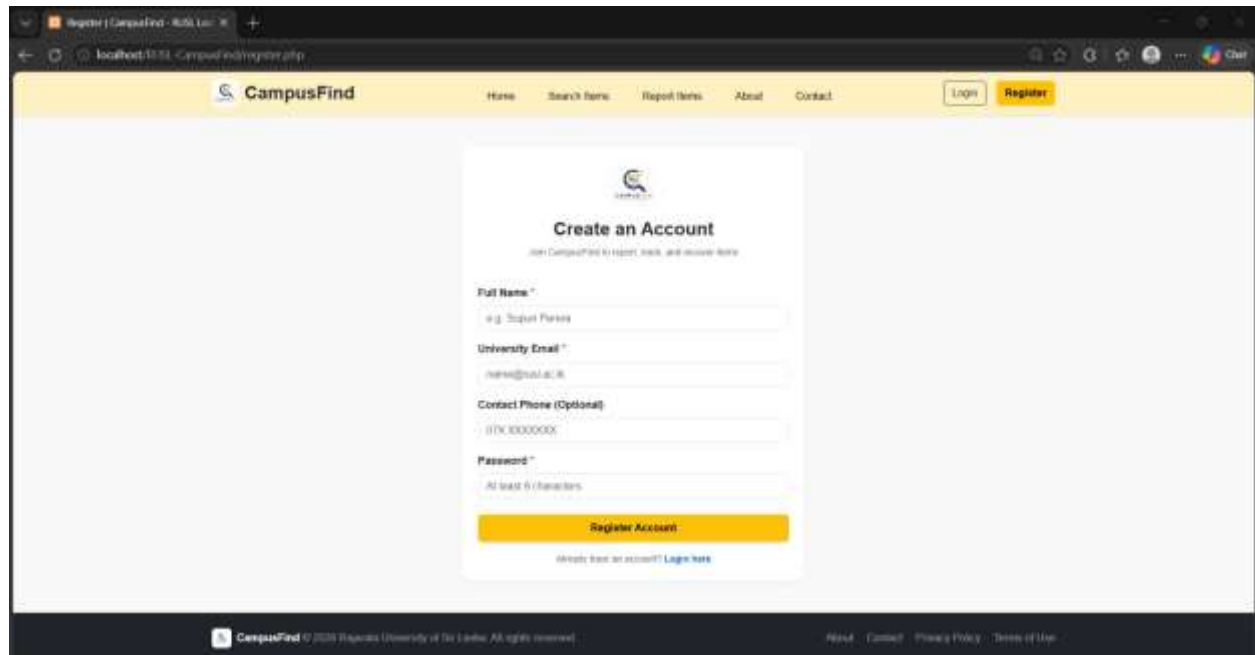
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text ("**© 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.**") and secondary links (*About, Contact, Privacy Policy, Terms of Use*).

3.2.Register Page

3.2.1. Feature: User Registration Page (register.php)

3.2.2. Short Explanation: Allows new students and staff members to register for a CampusFind account, securely saving user details into the database to enable lost and found item submission and management.

3.2.3. Screenshot:



3.2.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

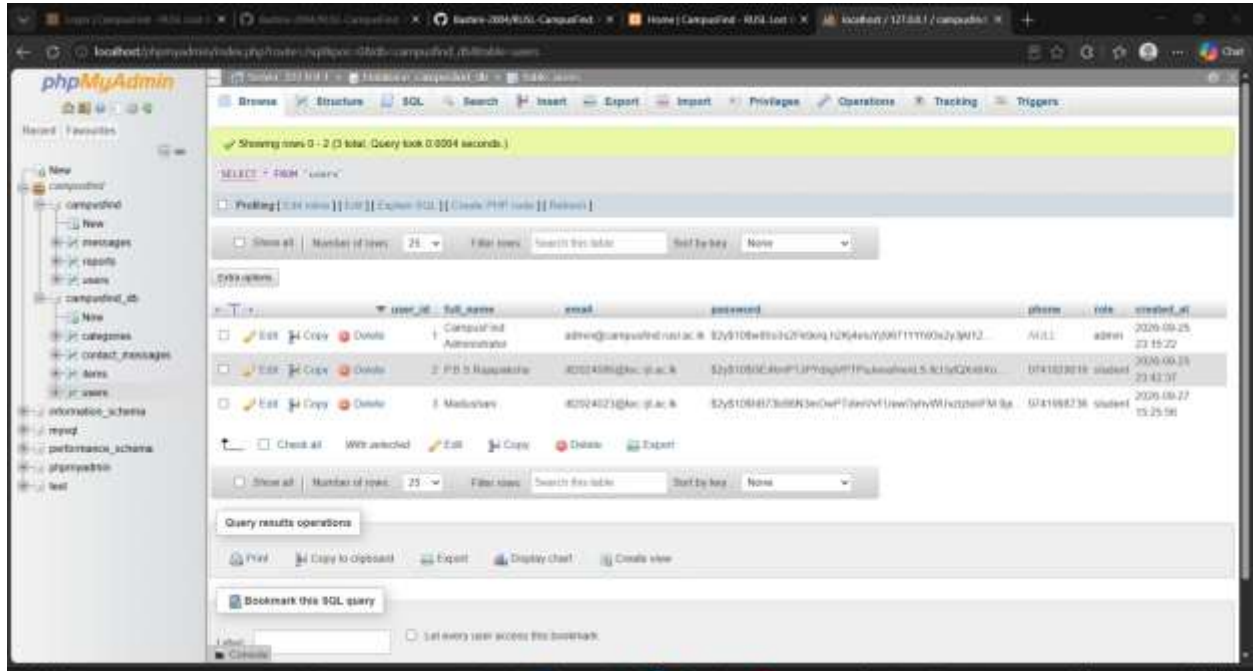
- **Header Navigation:** Features the top navigation bar containing the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and top-right action buttons (*Login* and highlighted *Register*).

- **Account Creation Container:** Displays a centered registration card with the CampusFind logo, heading *"Create an Account"*, and tagline *"Join CampusFind to report, track, and recover items"*.
- **Form Input Fields:** Includes input fields for *"Full Name"* (with placeholder e.g. Supun Perera), *"University Email"* (name@rusl.ac.lk), *"Contact Phone (Optional)"* (07X XXXXXXX), and *"Password"* with a length requirement of at least 6 characters.
- **Registration Controls & Navigation:** Features a prominent yellow *"Register Account"* button to send registration data to register_process.php for password hashing and database insertion, alongside a quick link (*"Already have an account? Login here"*) redirecting to login.php.
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text (*"© 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved."*) and policy links (*About, Contact, Privacy Policy, Terms of Use*).

3.2.5. Database connection

The screenshot shows a web browser displaying the 'Create an Account' page of the CampusFind application. The page has a yellow header bar with the CampusFind logo and navigation links: Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, and Contact. On the right side of the header are 'Login' and 'Register' buttons. The main content area features a centered white registration card. The card has the CampusFind logo at the top, followed by the heading 'Create an Account' and a tagline: 'Join CampusFind to report, track, and recover items'. Below this are four input fields: 'Full Name' (with placeholder 'P.B.S. Rajapaksha'), 'University Email' (with placeholder '0004088@rusl.ac.lk'), 'Contact Phone (Optional)' (with placeholder '0741629099'), and 'Password'. At the bottom of the card is a yellow 'Register Account' button and a link for users who already have an account: 'Already have an account? Login here'. The footer is a dark bar containing the CampusFind logo, copyright text '© 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.', and links for 'About', 'Contact', 'Privacy Policy', and 'Terms of Use'.





3.3.Home Page

3.3.1. Feature: Home Page (index.php / home.php)

3.3.2. Short Explanation: Serves as the primary landing page for CampusFind, welcoming users with call-to-action shortcuts and preview grids displaying recently reported lost and found items across the Rajarata University campus.

3.3.3. Screenshot:

 CampusFind

[Home](#) [Search Items](#) [Report Items](#) [About](#) [Contact](#)

[Login](#) [Register](#)

Lost Something?

We're here to help!

Search for lost items or report items you've found across Rajarata University campus.

[Search Items](#) [Report Item](#)



Recent Lost Items

[View All](#)



LOST

Category: Accessories

Umbrella

Black foldable umbrella...

Location: Cafeteria

Date Lost: 25 Jul 2026



LOST

Category: Keys

Key Set

3 Keys with university keychain...

Location: Parking Area

Date Lost: 25 May 2026



LOST

Category: Electronics

Mobile Phone

Black Samsung Phone with protective case...

Location: Cafeteria

Date Lost: 10 May 2026

Recent Found Items

[View All](#)



FOUND

Category: Bags

Black Backpack

Black School Backpack with books inside...

Location: ICT Building

Date Found: 25 Jul 2026



FOUND

Category: ID Cards

Student ID Card

Rajarata University Student ID Card...

Location: Library

Date Found: 24 Jul 2026



FOUND

Category: Others

Water Bottle

Blue stainless steel water bottle...

Location: Lecture Hall

Date Found: 23 Jul 2026

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[About](#) [Contact](#) [Privacy Policy](#) [Terms of Use](#)

3.3.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and quick action buttons (*Login* and *Register*).
- **Hero Banner Section:** Displays the welcome message "*Lost Something? We're here to help!*", brief explanatory text, two primary call-to-action buttons ("*Search Items*" and "*Report Item*"), and the CampusFind logo emblem with tagline "*Lost today, found tomorrow*".
- **Recent Lost Items Section:** Features a grid displaying recent lost item postings (e.g., *Umbrella, Key Set, Mobile Phone*) tagged with red "*LOST*" badges, category tags (*Accessories, Keys, Electronics*), location info (*Cafeteria, Parking Area*), dates lost, and a "*View All*" button.
- **Recent Found Items Section:** Displays a preview grid of recently recovered items (e.g., *Black Backpack, Student ID Card, Water Bottle*) marked with green "*FOUND*" badges, category tags (*Bags, ID Cards, Others*), campus locations (*ICT Building, Library, Lecture Hall*), dates found, and a direct "*View All*" link.
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright statement ("*CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.*") alongside links for *About, Contact, Privacy Policy, and Terms of Use*.

3.4. Search Items Page

3.4.1. Feature: Search Lost & Found Items Page (search.php)

- 3.4.2. Short Explanation:** Provides a searchable and filterable catalog where users can search for reported lost and found items across campus using keywords, categories, locations, and status filters.

3.4.3. Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the CampusFind website interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with links for Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, and Contact. A Login button and a Register button are also present. Below the navigation bar, the main heading is "Search Lost & Found Items" with a subtext: "Find your lost belongings or see if an item you found has been reported missing." A search bar is provided with the placeholder text "Search by item name or keyword...". To the right of the search bar are dropdown menus for "All Categories" and "All Locations", and a yellow "Filter" button. Below the search bar, there are three tabs: "All Items", "Lost Items", and "Found Items". The "Found Items" tab is selected, and it shows a list of found items. The items are displayed in a grid format, each with a photo, a category, a title, a description, and details about the location, date, time, and phone number. The items listed are: a Black Backpack (Found), an Umbrella (Lost), a Student ID Card (Found), a Water Bottle (Found), a Key Set (Lost), and a Mobile Phone (Lost). The footer of the website contains the text "CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved." and links for About, Contact, Privacy Policy, and Terms of Use.

CampusFind Home Search Items Report Items About Contact Login Register

Search Lost & Found Items
Find your lost belongings or see if an item you found has been reported missing.

Search by item name or keyword... All Categories All Locations Filter

All Items Lost Items Found Items Found 6 Items

Black Backpack (Found)
Black School Backpack with books inside
Location: ICT Building
Date: 25 Jul 2026
Time: 09:15 AM
Phone: Not provided

Umbrella (Lost)
Black foldable umbrella
Location: Cafeteria
Date: 25 Jul 2026
Time: 12:00 PM
Phone: Not provided

Student ID Card (Found)
Rajarata University Student ID Card
Location: Library
Date: 24 Jul 2026
Time: 11:30 AM
Phone: Not provided

Water Bottle (Found)
Blue stainless steel water bottle
Location: Lecture Hall
Date: 23 Jul 2026
Time: 02:15 PM
Phone: Not provided

Key Set (Lost)
3 Keys with university keychain
Location: Parking Area
Date: 25 May 2026
Time: 02:30 PM
Phone: Not provided

Mobile Phone (Lost)
Black Samsung Phone with protective case
Location: Cafeteria
Date: 18 May 2026
Time: 10:00 AM
Phone: Not provided

CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved. About Contact Privacy Policy Terms of Use

3.4.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and action buttons (*Login and Register*).
- **Search & Filter Controls:** Provides a unified search toolbar containing a keyword search input box ("*Search by item name or keyword...*"), dropdown selectors for "*All Categories*" and "*All Locations*", and a yellow "*Filter*" button.
- **Status Filter Tabs & Result Count:** Features quick-toggle status tabs ("*All Items*", "*Lost Items*", "*Found Items*") and a live counter displaying total results ("*Found 6 items*").
- **Listing Grid Display:** Displays item cards showcasing:
 - **Status & Category Badges:** Visual status indicators ("*FOUND*" in green, "*LOST*" in red) and category tags (*Bags, Accessories, ID Cards, Others, Keys, Electronics*).
 - **Item Details:** Item photos, titles (e.g., *Black Backpack, Student ID Card, Mobile Phone*), and brief descriptions.
 - **Incident Metadata:** Specific event information including campus *Location* (*ICT Building, Cafeteria, Library, Lecture Hall, Parking Area*), *Date, Time*, and contact phone availability.
 - **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text ("*CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.*") alongside links for *About, Contact, Privacy Policy, and Terms of Use*.

3.5. Report Items Page

3.5.1. Feature: Report Lost or Found Item Page (report.php)

3.5.2. Short Explanation: Provides an interactive web form for users to report lost or found items, capturing essential item details, event locations, dates, optional image attachments, and contact information for backend database processing.

3.5.3. Screenshot:

CampusFind

Home Search Items Report Items About Contact Login Register

Report Lost or Found Item

Please provide accurate details about the item so we can contact it with the owner

What would you like to report?

☒ I lost an item ☐ I found an item

Item Name *

e.g. Student ID, Samsung Galaxy, Black Backpack

Category *

Select Category

Description *

Provide distinguishing details (e.g. color, brand, photos, unique features, contact details)

Date *

mm/dd/yyyy

Location *

Where was it lost/found?

Approx. Time

--:--

Upload Photo

Choose File No file chosen

Contact Email *

Enter an email address

PDF, PNG or JPG (Max 10MB) (Optional recommendations)

☐ Make Your contact details visible to users to facilitate returning the item securely

Submit Report

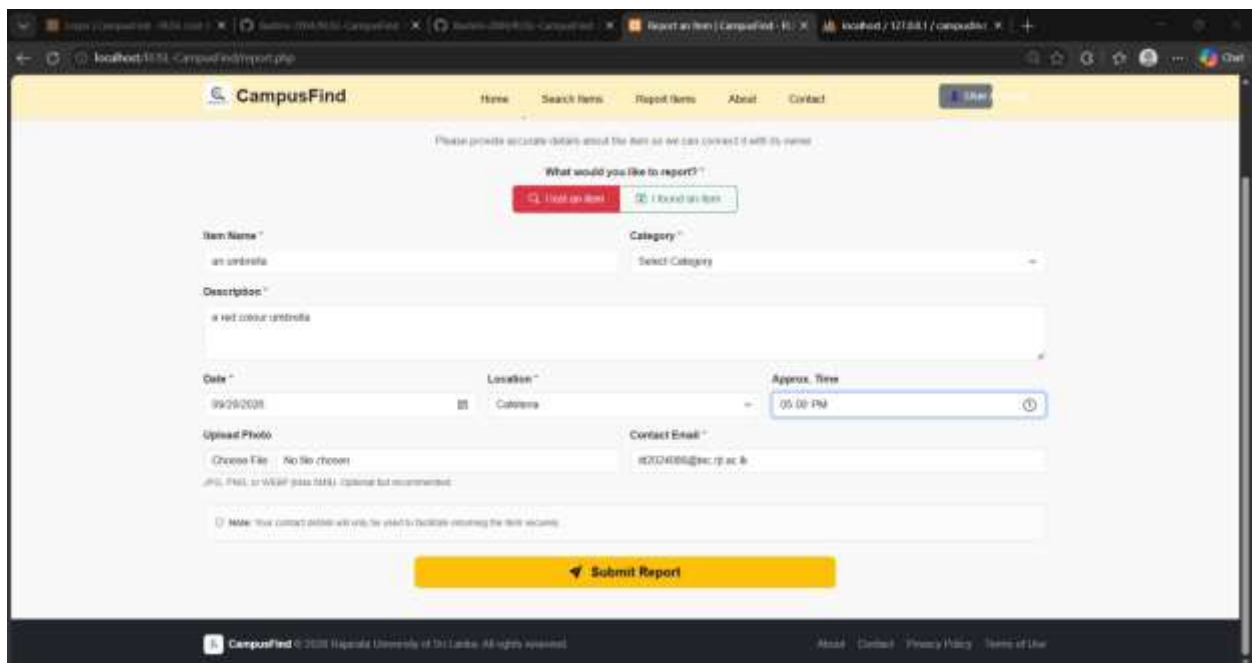
CampusFind © 2020 University of St. Lawrence. All rights reserved. About Contact Privacy Policy Terms of Use

3.5.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- Header Navigation:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home*, *Search Items*, *Report Items*, *About*, *Contact*), and action buttons (*Login* and *Register*).
- Report Type Selection:** Interactive toggle buttons under "*What would you like to report?*" allowing users to switch between "*I lost an item*" (active in red) and "*I found an item*".
- Item Information Fields:** Includes input fields for "*Item Name*" (with placeholder e.g. Student ID, Samsung Galaxy, Black Backpack), a category dropdown filter ("*Select Category*"), and a multi-line "*Description*" text box for distinguishing details.
- Event & Location Details:** Input controls to specify the event "*Date*" (mm/dd/yyyy), "*Location*" dropdown (Where was it lost/found?), and "*Approx. Time*".

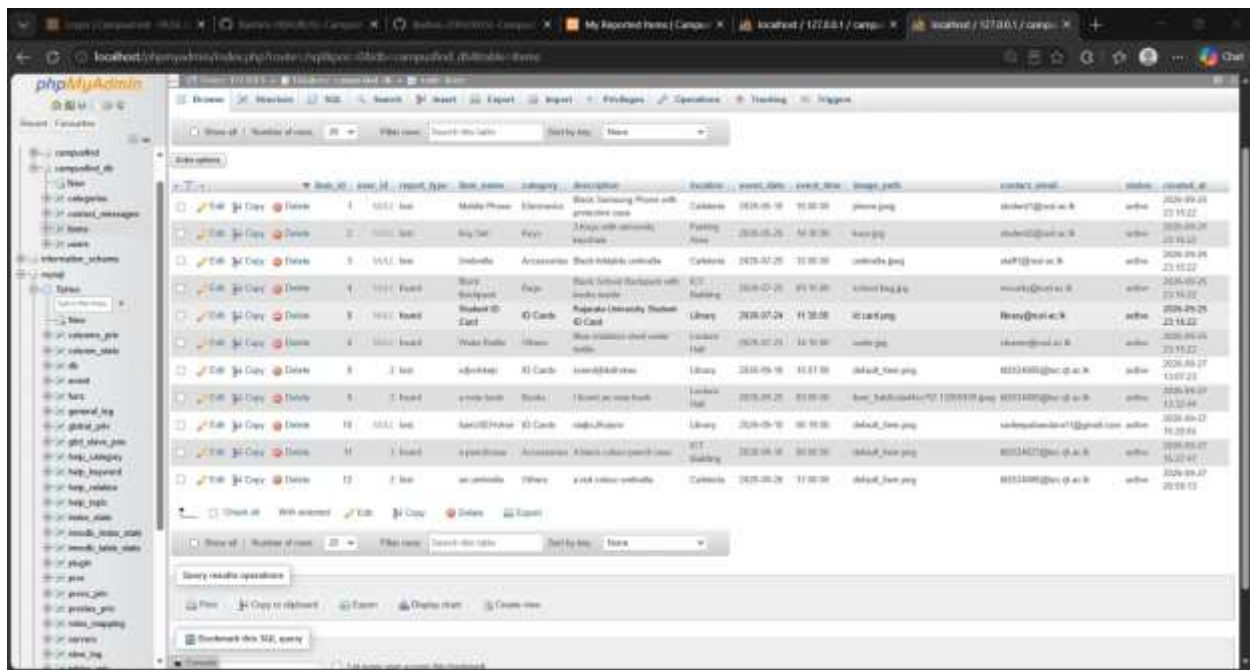
- **Photo Upload & Contact Info:** A file input section for *"Upload Photo"* (supporting JPG, PNG, or WEBP up to 5MB) and a *"Contact Email"* input box accompanied by a privacy notice regarding contact security.
- **Submission Action:** A prominent yellow *"Submit Report"* button with a paper plane icon to send the form data to report_process.php for database storage.
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text (*"CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved."*) alongside links for *About*, *Contact*, *Privacy Policy*, and *Terms of Use*.

3.5.5. Database connection



The screenshot shows a web browser window displaying the 'CampusFind' report submission form. The form is titled 'What would you like to report?' and includes several input fields: 'Item Name' (with a placeholder 'an umbrella'), 'Category' (a dropdown menu), 'Description' (with a placeholder 'a HOT colour umbrella'), 'Date' (set to '09/28/2025'), 'Location' (set to 'Cafeteria'), 'Approx. Time' (set to '05:00 PM'), 'Upload Photo' (with a file input and a note 'Choose File No file chosen'), and 'Contact Email' (with a placeholder 'it2024008@rc.rps.ac.lk'). A prominent yellow 'Submit Report' button is at the bottom. The footer contains the copyright text 'CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.' and links for 'About', 'Contact', 'Privacy Policy', and 'Terms of Use'.



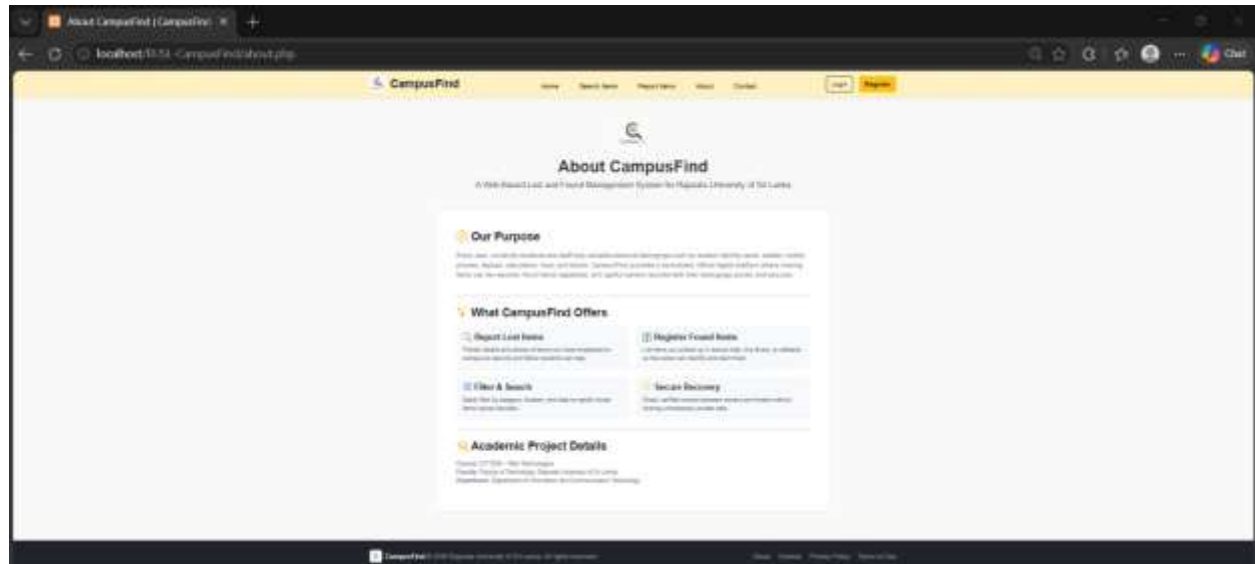


3.6. About Page

3.6.1. Feature: About Page (about.php)

3.6.2. Short Explanation: Displays background information about the CampusFind system, detailing its purpose, feature offerings, and academic course alignment within Rajaratna University of Sri Lanka.

3.6.3. Screenshot:



3.6.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Top Navigation Header:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, main navigation links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and top-right auth buttons (*Login* and *Register*).
- **Page Title & Subtitle:** Displays the CampusFind icon, main heading "*About CampusFind*", and the subtitle "*A Web-Based Lost and Found Management System for Rajarata University of Sri Lanka*".
- **Our Purpose Section:** Outlines the core objective of providing a centralized, official digital platform for students and staff to report and recover lost personal belongings.
- **What CampusFind Offers Section:** Features a 2x2 grid card display highlighting key system capabilities:
 - "*Report Lost Items*" (publishing item details and photos)
 - "*Register Found Items*" (listing items found around campus halls, library, or cafeteria)
 - "*Filter & Search*" (filtering by category, location, and date)
 - "*Secure Recovery*" (enabling safe contact between finders and owners)
- **Academic Project Details:** Shows the course affiliation details including *Course: ICT1209 - Web Technologies, Faculty: Faculty of Technology, Rajarata*

University of Sri Lanka, and Department: Department of Information and Communication Technology.

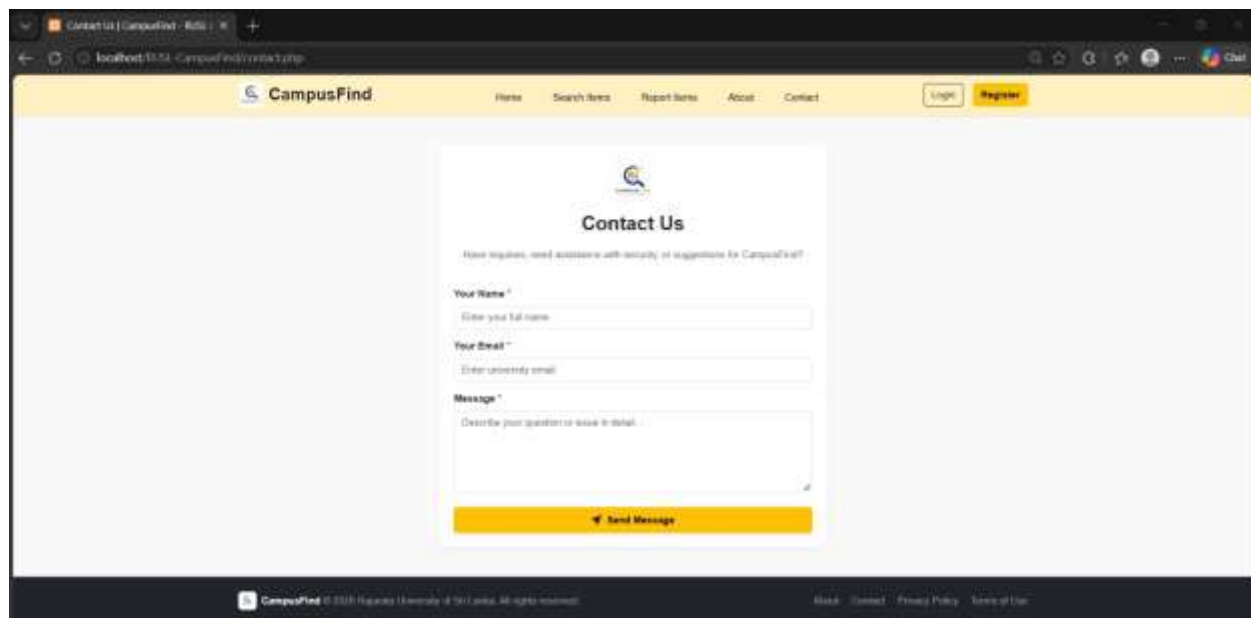
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text ("*CampusFind* © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.") alongside links for *About*, *Contact*, *Privacy Policy*, and *Terms of Use*.

3.7.Contact Page

3.7.1. Feature: Contact Us Page (contact.php)

3.7.2. Short Explanation: Provides an interactive communication form enabling students and staff to submit inquiries, feedback, or support requests directly to the CampusFind system administration.

3.7.3. Screenshot:

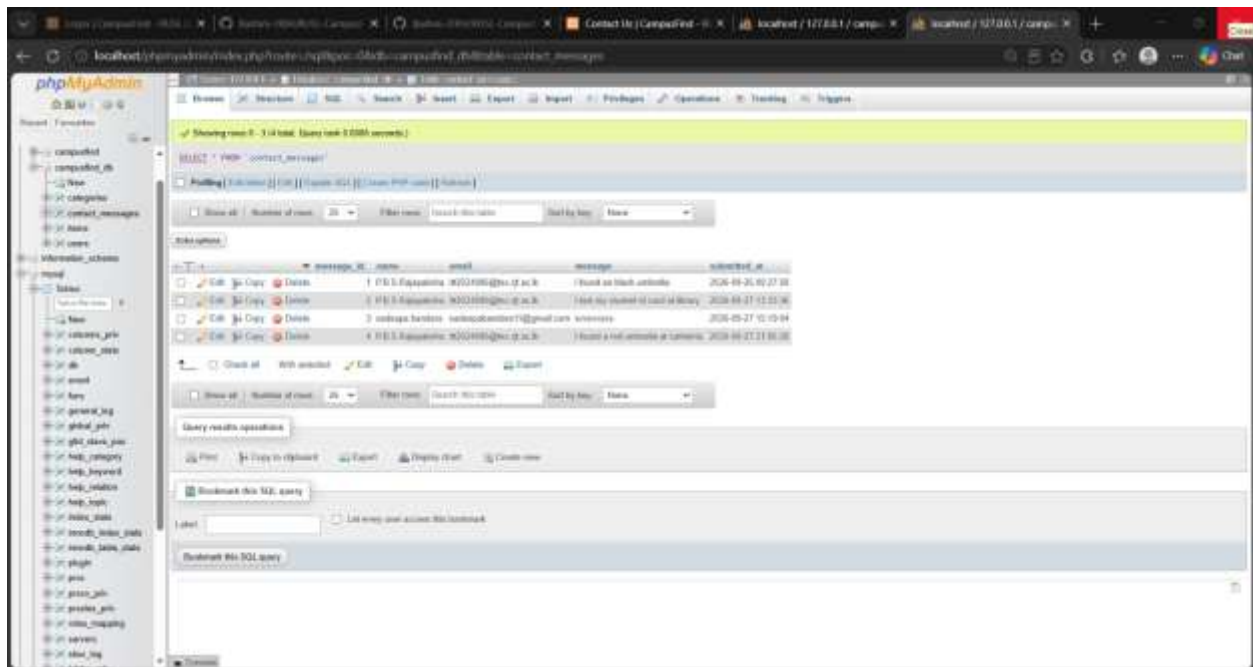
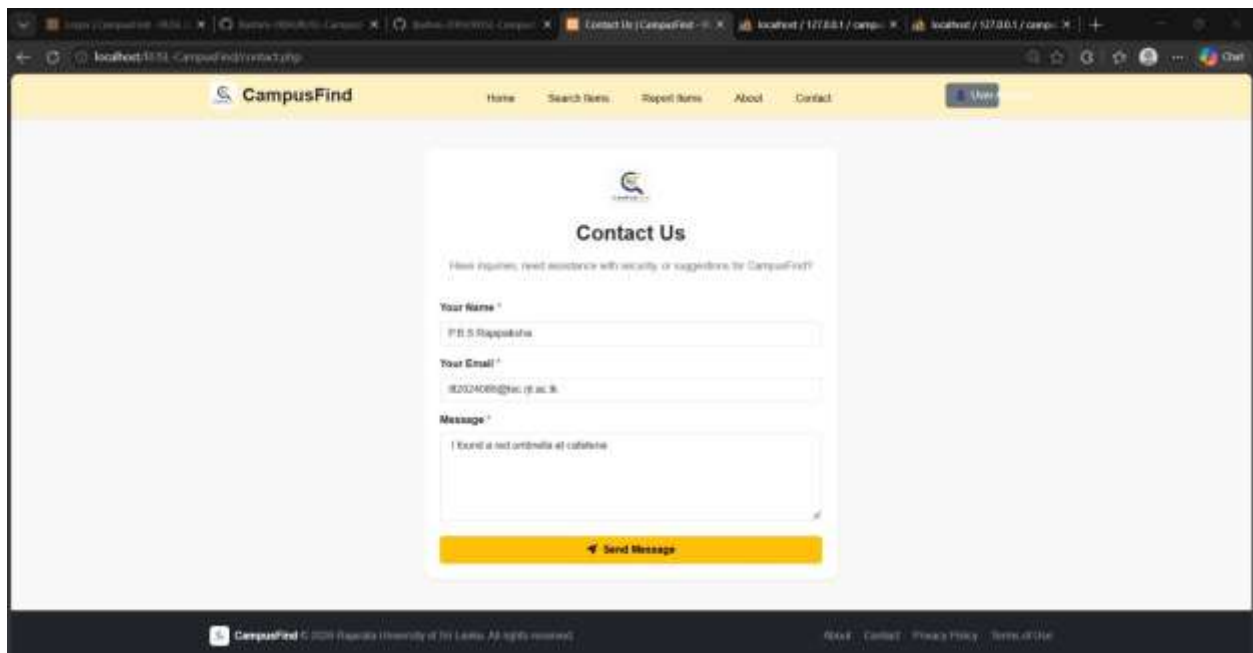


3.7.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top bar with the CampusFind logo, main navigation links (*Home*, *Search Items*, *Report Items*, *About*, *Contact*), and top-right auth buttons (*Login* and *Register*).

- **Contact Card Container:** Displays a centered white card featuring the CampusFind logo, heading *"Contact Us"*, and prompt *"Have inquiries, need assistance with security, or suggestions for CampusFind?"*.
- **Form Input Fields:** Includes required input fields for *"Your Name *"* (Enter your full name), *"Your Email *"* (Enter university email), and a multi-line *"Message *"* text box (Describe your question or issue in detail...).
- **Submission Action:** Contains a prominent yellow *"Send Message"* button with a paper plane icon to submit the inquiry to `contact_process.php` for database processing.
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text (*"CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved."*) alongside links for *About*, *Contact*, *Privacy Policy*, and *Terms of Use*.

3.7.5. Database connection

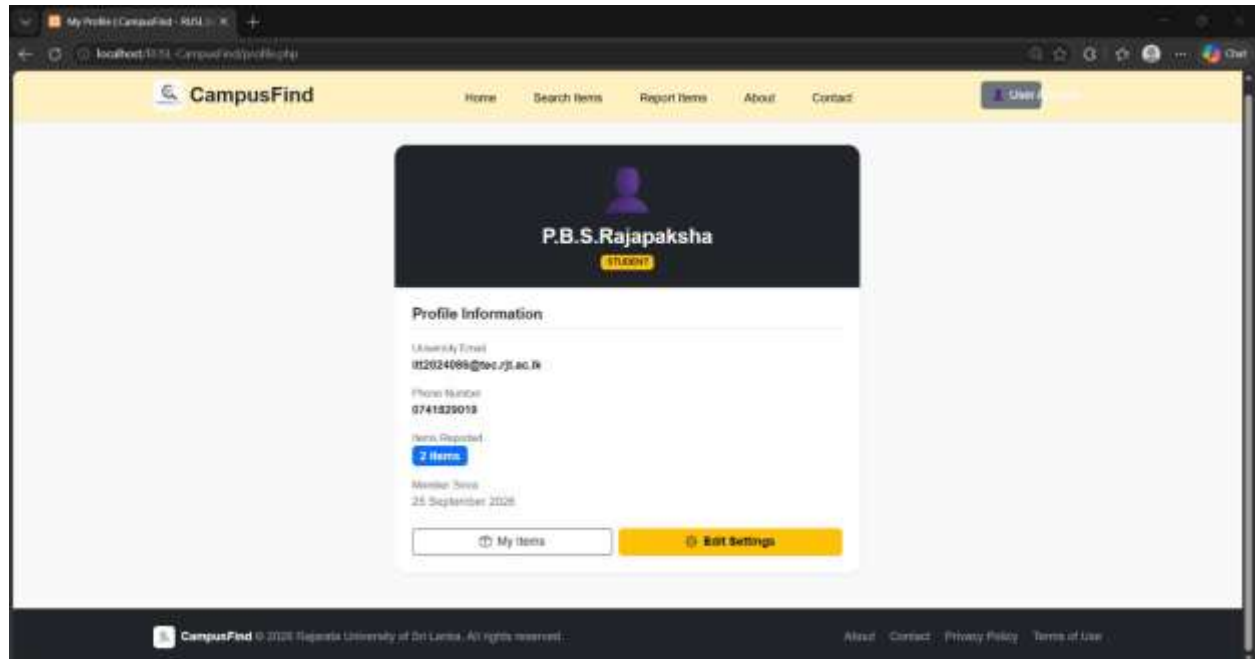


3.8. My Profile

3.8.1. Feature: User Profile Page (profile.php)

3.8.2. Short Explanation: Displays account details for logged-in users, including user role, personal contact information, total reported items count, registration date, and quick action buttons to view personal listings or edit account settings.

3.8.3. Screenshot:



3.8.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and the active *User Account* dropdown menu.
- **Profile Header Card:** Displays the user avatar silhouette, full account name (*P.B.S.Rajapaksha*), and user role badge (*STUDENT*).
- **Profile Information Section:** Lists key account metadata, including *University Email* (itt2024086@tec.rjt.ac.lk), *Phone Number* (0741829019), total *Items Reported* (2 items), and *Member Since* date (25 September 2026).

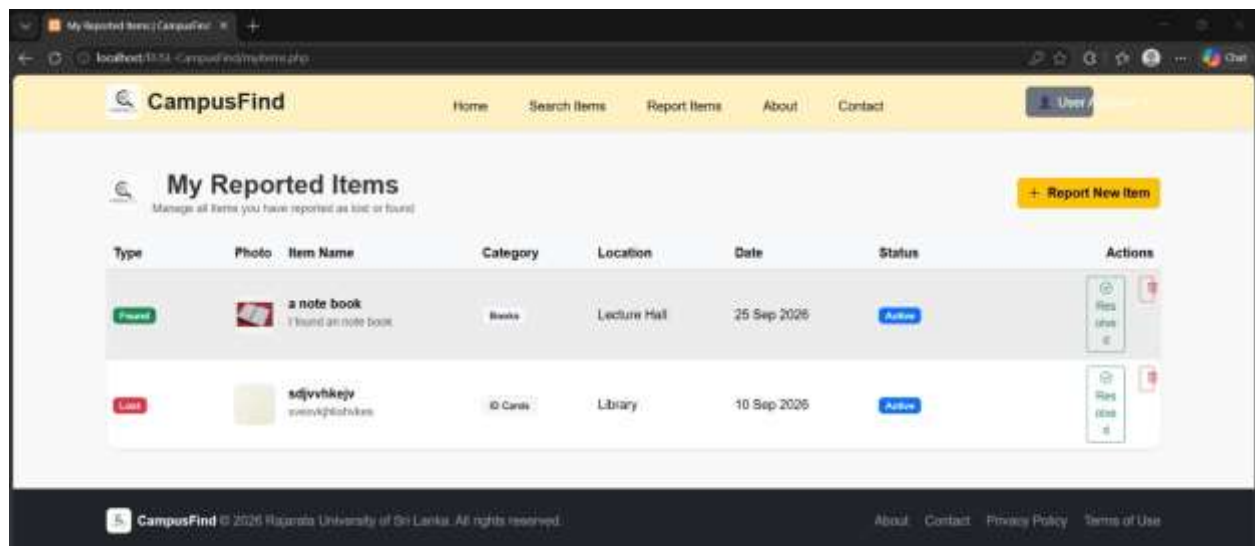
- **Action Controls:** Features interactive quick-action buttons for *"My Items"* (to view and manage submitted items) and *"Edit Settings"* (to update profile information).
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying the copyright text (*"CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved."*) alongside links for *About*, *Contact*, *Privacy Policy*, and *Terms of Use*.

3.9.My Items

3.9.1. Feature: My Items Page (myitems.php)

3.9.2. Short Explanation: Displays a tabular dashboard where logged-in users can view, manage, mark as resolved, or delete all lost and found items they have previously submitted.

3.9.3. Screenshot:



3.9.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

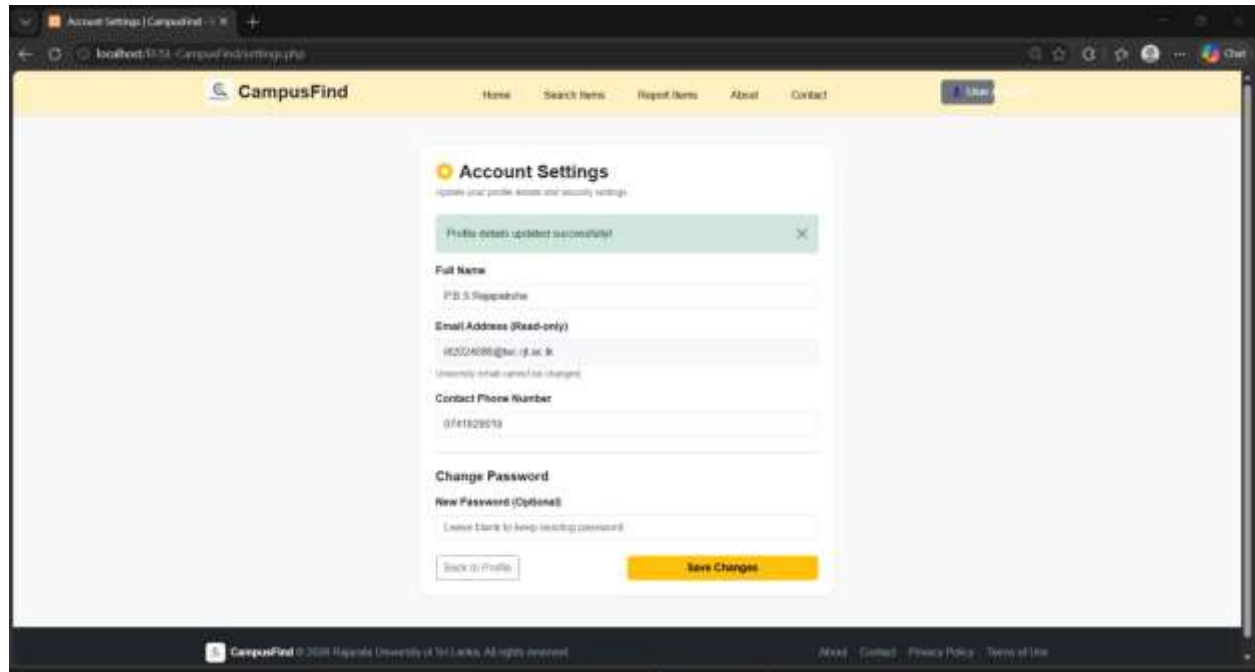
- **Header Navigation Bar:** Displays the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and the active *User Account* dropdown menu.
- **Page Header & Direct Action:** Features the title "*My Reported Items*", subtitle "*Manage all items you have reported as lost or found*", and a top-right yellow "+ *Report New Item*" shortcut button redirecting to `report.php`.
- **Reported Items Table:** Organizes user-submitted items into a clean data table with clear column fields:
- **Type:** Badges indicating whether an item is reported as "*Found*" (green badge) or "*Lost*" (red badge).
- **Photo & Item Name:** Displays item image thumbnails alongside titles ("*a note book*", "*sdjvvhkejv*") and descriptions.
- **Category & Location:** Classification tags (*Books, ID Cards*) and campus locations (*Lecture Hall, Library*).
- **Date & Status:** Incident submission dates (*25 Sep 2026, 10 Sep 2026*) and current active status badges (*Active*).
- **Listing Management Actions:** Includes action controls for each entry, featuring a green "*Resolved*" button to change item status upon recovery and a red trash icon button to delete the record.
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying copyright information ("*CampusFind © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.*") alongside links for *About, Contact, Privacy Policy, and Terms of Use*.

3.10. Settings

3.10.1. Feature: Account Settings Page (`settings.php`)

3.10.2. Short Explanation: Allows logged-in users to update their personal account details (such as full name and phone number), review their read-only university email, and update password security settings.

3.10.3. Screenshot:



3.10.4. What the Screenshot Shows:

- **Header Navigation:** Features the standard top navigation bar with the CampusFind logo, primary page links (*Home, Search Items, Report Items, About, Contact*), and the active *User Account* dropdown menu.
- **System Alert Banner:** Displays a green success notification banner reading *"Profile details updated successfully!"* at the top of the form.
- **Profile Details Section:** Contains input fields for *"Full Name"* (P.B.S.Rajapaksha), a read-only *"Email Address"* (itt2024086@tec.rjt.ac.lk) accompanied by an explanatory note (*"University email cannot be changed."*), and *"Contact Phone Number"* (0741829019).
- **Security Settings Section:** Includes a *"Change Password"* sub-section with a *"New Password (Optional)"* field and guidance text (*"Leave blank to keep existing password"*).
- **Action Buttons:** Features a *"Back to Profile"* link button to return to profile.php alongside a yellow *"Save Changes"* button to save updated profile information to the database.

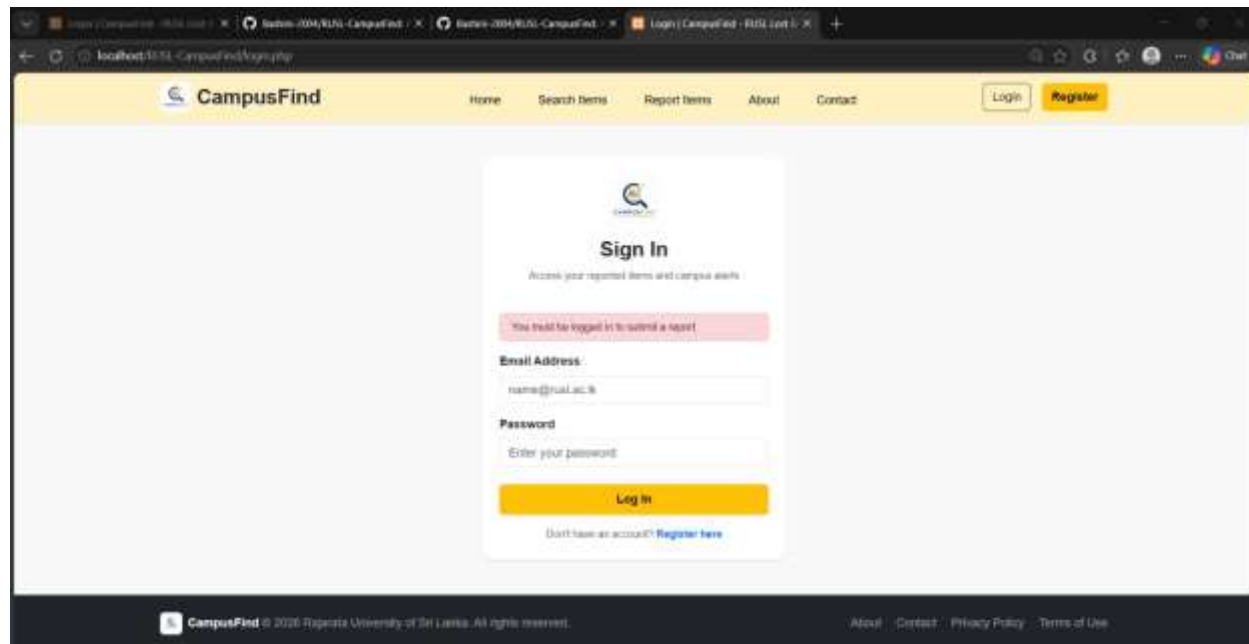
- **Footer Navigation:** A full-width dark footer displaying copyright information ("*CampusFind* © 2026 Rajarata University of Sri Lanka. All rights reserved.") and secondary links (*About, Contact, Privacy Policy, Terms of Use*).

3.11. User Authentication and Access Control

3.11.1. Login Required for Reporting Items

The system was designed so that users must sign in before reporting a lost or found. This prevents users who are not logged in from submitting item reports and helps maintain controlled access to the reporting functions.

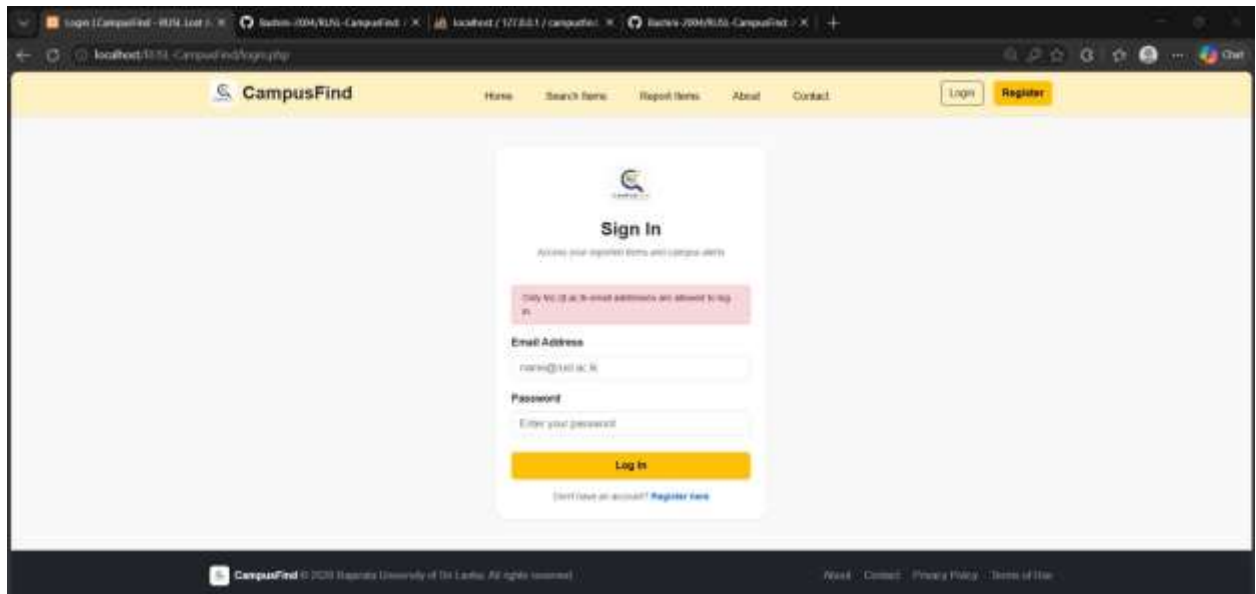
- **Screenshot**



3.11.2. University Email Restriction

An additional email validation feature was implemented to restrict registration to users with a valid @tec.rjt.ac.lk university email address. This helps ensure that the system is accessible only to users with an appropriate university email account.

- **Screenshot**



4. Challenges and Solutions

4.1. Selecting a Suitable Project Theme

Challenge:

As first-year students, we initially found it difficult to select a suitable project idea. We wanted to develop something useful for students.

Solution:

After discussing different ideas, we decided to develop a Lost and Found Web Application to help students report and search for lost and found items.

4.2. Difficulty in Creating the Figma Design

Challenge:

We had limited experience with Figma. Some designs were accidentally deleted, and we also struggled to create and arrange the pages correctly.

Solution:

We practiced using Figma and referred to online learning resources.

Through repeated practice, we improved our designs and completed the required pages.

4.3. Converting Figma Design into Code

Challenge:

We initially expected the conversion from Figma to code to be easy. However, developing the frontend using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and JavaScript were more difficult than expected.

Solution:

We developed the pages step by step and tested them regularly. When the output was incorrect, we checked the code, identified the errors, and corrected them through repeated testing.

4.4. GitHub Collaboration

Challenge:

We created separate GitHub accounts and tried to work on the same repository using two different computers. Due to our limited GitHub knowledge, we could not successfully manage the push and pull process and keep both computers synchronized.

Solution:

We worked together by developing and checking the code and then combining the completed work into one repository. We learned the basic concepts of GitHub and plan to improve our skills and use proper collaboration with separate computers in future projects.

4.5. Backend Development with PHP

Challenge:

PHP was challenging because we had limited experience with backend development. We also faced errors when combining PHP and HTML files.

Solution:

We referred to documentation, tutorials, and AI-assisted learning tools to understand the code. We tested and modified the code and fixed errors before integrating the files.

4.6.Connecting PHP with MySQL

Challenge:

Connecting the PHP forms with the MySQL database was one of the most difficult parts. Initially, the information entered through the forms was not stored in the database.

Solution:

We checked the database connection, table and column names, form fields, and PHP queries. By testing each part and correcting the errors, we successfully connected the forms with the database.

4.7.Debugging and Teamwork

Challenge:

Sometimes the code did not produce the expected output, and developing pages together took more time.

Solution:

We divided the pages between us, developed them separately, and reviewed each other's work. We also debugged the code step by step to identify and fix errors.

4.8.Overall Learning

Although we faced several challenges, this project helped us gain practical experience in **Figma, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL, VS Code, and GitHub**. It also improved our problem-solving, debugging, and teamwork skills.

5. Individual contribution

5.1. Individual Contribution

Both group members contributed to the planning, design, development, testing, and integration of the Lost and Found Web Application. As first-year students, we initially worked together to understand the project requirements and develop the first few pages. Later, we divided the remaining pages between us to complete the work more efficiently.

5.2. Member 1 – G.G.C.M. Chandrarathna

- Participated in selecting the project theme and planning the system.
- Created the overall Figma design for the project.
- Developed the **Home, Search, Lost and Found Item** pages using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and JavaScript in Visual Studio Code.
- Contributed to the development of the **PHP backend** and **MySQL database integration**.
- Worked on connecting the frontend pages with the backend and database.
- Tested and debugged the developed frontend pages.
- Contributed to combining and checking the final project files.

5.3. Member 2 – P.B.S. Rajapaksha

- Participated in selecting the project theme and planning the system.
- Contributed to reviewing the overall Figma design.
- Developed the **Report Item** and **About** pages using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and JavaScript in Visual Studio Code.
- Developed the **PHP backend** and worked on the **MySQL database integration**.
- Tested and debugged the backend and database functions.

5.4.Joint Contribution

We worked together throughout the project, especially during the initial design and development stages. We discussed problems, tested each other's work, and helped solve errors. Although we were unable to fully collaborate through GitHub on separate computers, we continued working together by developing the project and combining the completed work into one repository. This allowed both members to contribute to the final project.

6. Setup instructions

The RUSL-CampusFind web application was developed using PHP and MySQL and can be run locally using XAMPP. The following steps explain how to set up and run the system.

6.1.Install XAMPP

Install XAMPP on the computer. XAMPP provides the Apache web server and MySQL database required to run the application.

6.2.Copy the Project Files

Copy the RUSL-CampusFind project folder into the htdocs folder inside the XAMPP installation directory.

Example:

C:\xampp\htdocs\RUSL-CampusFind

6.3.Start XAMPP Services

Open the XAMPP Control Panel and start:

- Apache
- MySQL

6.4.Create and Import the Database

Open phpMyAdmin from the XAMPP Control Panel. Create a database named campusfind and import the provided database.sql file. This will create the tables required by the application.

6.5.Configure the Database Connection

Check the database connection settings in the PHP connection file. Make sure the database name is set to campusfind and that the username, password, and server details match the local MySQL configuration.

6.6.Run the Application

Open a web browser and enter:

<http://localhost/RUSL-CampusFind/>

The RUSL-CampusFind application should then open through the local XAMPP server.

6.7.Test the System

After starting the application, test the main functions such as registration, login, searching for lost and found items, reporting items, and submitting forms. This helps confirm that the frontend, PHP backend, and database are working correctly.

7. References

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